custody battle, and no great principles emerge out of it. This is a book about my life as a journalist and as a fighter for freedoms: my children are not part of that story and I won't say much more about them. There is Daniel and there are other children born to people I cared about. Over my career so far, when I speak about the need for truth, I am talking, very often, about the truth in relation to the deaths of thousands of people. Or I am talking about frauds, tortures, corruptions that destroyed people's lives. Despite the wishes of the category error-makers, I will not insult that legacy by suggesting some kind of equivalence between those truths and my own small concerns. I will reveal to you the growth of a mind, and an attitude, a sensibility, and a plan. I will talk to you about criminal charges brought against me. But I will not pour forth on issues that matter only to my family and which can add nothing to your sense of the personal journey towards the work of WikiLeaks. Disclosure is my business, but we don't deal in gossip.

I've got ahead of myself. The cypherpunks' mailing list, and with it the movement, was launched in 1992 and would capture my attention during the middle years of the decade. But let me take you back to 1990. Just before Daniel was born, my girlfriend and I had been living in untraceable accommodation in Fitzroy, a bohemian suburb of Melbourne. Fitzroy had an Italian population and a Greek crowd and lots of students, all of whom felt comfortable being near the university. We began squatting. And many of our political thoughts at the time – thoughts that would lead to bigger questions about ownership of information and so on – were centred around the issue of squatters' rights. We formed a squatters' union. I would put posters on lamp-posts and encourage people to call into our office with information about empty properties. I'd plot them on a map, then go round there and work out how to break in. We kept filing cards of these places, and noted whether they had working gas and electricity, how long they were likely to be empty and stuff like that. My girlfriend and I moved into an Edwardian property and made an issue of the freedom to use these properties and the rights adhering to occupants. I realised I was probably built for struggle because this wasn't the easiest way to live. Conditions of threat suited me and made me work harder. Anyway, we were tossed out of that house but the union worked well, giving homeless people a place to call. The way of organising it was interesting: we behaved like a real estate